

WEBSITE DESIGN PROPOSAL

DURO DESIGN GROUP

Two-Tier Modern Web Package • Next.js + AI-Enabled

Essential • Competitive

Starting at \$3,500 | Up to 75% off standard agency rates

Every build ships within 2 months

Prepared by The Livingstone Solution

April 2026 | Prepared for DURO Design Group, LLC

1. Context

This proposal flows directly from the Market Intelligence Report we delivered this month. Short version: DURO is a credible, award-winning A+E firm with a real portfolio — Eastern Market, Walter Pierce Park, the Thurgood Marshall Center, the African American Civil War Museum, Harbor Bank of Maryland HQ — and the 2024 ULI Wavemaker Award. None of it is visible online. DURO's current digital maturity benchmarks at roughly 0.5 out of 10. Every direct competitor has a working website; DURO does not.

Three objectives

1. Make DURO discoverable — to DGS, DDOT, and DC Water procurement, to GC teaming partners, and to senior-designer recruits.
2. Tell the integrated A+E story, which solves the #1 pain point in the VOC research (subconsultant finger-pointing).
3. Rank DURO everywhere — traditional search (Google) and AI search (ChatGPT, Perplexity, Claude, Gemini). Generative Engine Optimization (GEO) is how DURO gets recommended by AI when a procurement officer asks “who does preservation + net-zero in DC.”

2. The Stack

We build on a modern web stack — not WordPress or Webflow. Three reasons: performance, AI-readiness, and the ability to ship features (client portals, booking, AI agents) that template platforms simply can't support.

What we use

- **Next.js 14 + React** — the framework powering the fastest sites on the web (Notion, TikTok, Hulu, OpenAI).
- **TypeScript** — type-safe code that ships with fewer bugs.
- **Tailwind CSS** — design-system-first styling so DURO's brand is consistent across every page.
- **Headless CMS (Payload or Sanity)** — your team edits project case studies, team bios, and insights without touching code.
- **Vercel hosting + edge network** — sub-second load times globally; same infra as every modern tech company. Hosting is quoted separately.

Why this matters for DURO

- Every DMV peer we benchmarked (Quinn Evans, Hickok Cole, EHT Traceries, Sorg, Bell) runs on WordPress or off-the-shelf platforms. DURO will be the most technically capable architecture-firm website in the DMV — a visible proof-point of how DURO approaches problems.
- The stack is future-proof. When DURO wants to add a new feature — a bid-pipeline dashboard, a Section-106 checklist tool, a real-time permit-status feed — we add it as a module. We never rebuild.
- AI-native from day one. GEO and AI agent features require a modern JavaScript stack; they are effectively impossible on WordPress.

3. Two-Tier Summary

Each tier is self-contained. DURO can start at any tier and upgrade later; the site is built to grow.

Tier	Best for	DURO price	Market rate	You save
Tier 1 — Essential Presence	Getting a credible online footprint up fast	\$3,500	\$10,000 – \$15,000	~70%
Tier 2 — Competitive Parity	Matching EHT Traceries and Bell Architects, with AI search visibility	\$6,400	\$22,000 – \$32,000	~75%

A note on the discount.

Market rates below reflect typical agency quotes for a comparable professional-services firm in the DC metro — sourced from published agency rate cards and benchmark RFPs. DURO’s prices are substantially below market because The Livingstone Solution is positioning DURO as a showcase client and an ongoing technology partner, not a one-off web project. Hosting and long-term support sit on a separate monthly partnership (see §7).

4. What's in Each Tier

Each card shows DURO's price, typical market rate for a comparable Next.js build, and the full scope of work.

TIER 1 — ESSENTIAL PRESENCE

Fast, credible, online in 3–4 weeks

DURO Price

\$3,500

Typical market rate:

\$10,000 – \$15,000

Save ~70%

- 5-page Next.js site: Home, About, Services, Projects, Contact
- Mobile-responsive, fast-loading (Lighthouse 90+), accessible (WCAG AA basics)
- 5 project case studies sourced from your deck: Walter Pierce, Eastern Market, Harbor Bank HQ, Thurgood Marshall Center, African American Civil War Museum
- Capabilities-statement download (PDF mirror of your existing one)
- Contact form piped to your email
- Basic on-page SEO: title/meta, Organization schema, sitemap, robots.txt
- Google Business Profile claim + optimization at 5112 11th St NE
- SAM.gov / AIA|DC / DSLBD CBE directory profile refresh checklist
- Domain purchase handled (DNS delegated to you)
- Training handoff: a 30-minute walkthrough so your team can update content via the CMS
- Delivery: 3–4 weeks
- Hosting: not included — see \$7 partnership retainer

TIER 2 — COMPETITIVE PARITY

Match EHT Traceries and Bell Architects, plus AI-search visibility

DURO Price

\$6,400

Typical market rate:

\$22,000 – \$32,000

Save ~75%

- Everything in Tier 1, plus:
- 8–10 page custom-designed Next.js site with full CMS (Payload or Sanity)

- Expanded portfolio: 8 project case studies with before/after galleries, project facts (client, scope, \$, size, dates), embedded renderings and photos
- Team / leadership page with headshots, bios, discipline tags, LinkedIn links
- Services deep-dive: Architecture, MEP, Structural, Civil, Permitting — each with its own page
- Insights hub (articles) seeded with 3 launch pieces we write: (a) 'Historic Preservation Meets Net-Zero in DC's 2027 Deadline', (b) 'The Case for Single-Signature Integrated A+E on DGS Projects', (c) 'What DC Procurement Officers Actually Want to See on an IDIQ Submittal'
- LinkedIn company page setup + 90-day content calendar (12 posts)
- Full on-page SEO: keyword research for DC / DGS / preservation terms, schema.org CreativeWork markup on case studies, Core Web Vitals optimization
- GEO — Generative Engine Optimization: we structure your content so ChatGPT, Perplexity, Claude, and Gemini recommend DURO when asked about DC preservation, integrated A+E, CBE-certified design firms, or net-zero heritage retrofits
- Google Analytics 4 + Search Console + monthly analytics email in your inbox
- Appointment booking widget (Cal.com or Calendly) wired to your calendar for RFQ-intro calls
- Press-kit page with ULI Wavemaker Award coverage, capabilities PDF, team bios
- Delivery: 6–7 weeks

5. Feature Comparison Matrix

Feature	Tier 1	Tier 2
Built on Next.js + modern stack	✓	✓
Pages	5	8–10 custom
Headless CMS (Payload/Sanity)	Basic	Full
Project case studies	5 static	8 with galleries
Insights / articles	—	3 launch articles (written by us)
SEO (on-page + schema)	Basic	Full
GEO (Generative Engine Optimization)	—	Included
Google Analytics 4 + Search Console	—	✓
LinkedIn page + content calendar	—	✓
Appointment booking widget	—	✓ (Cal.com)
Accessibility	Basics	Basics + contrast audit
Directory registrations (SAM.gov, CBE, AIA DC)	Checklist	Done for you
Training / handoff	30-min walkthrough	Structured 1-hour session
Delivery window	3–4 weeks	6–7 weeks
Hosting	Separate (see §7)	Separate (see §7)

Upgrading later. Both tiers use the same Next.js + CMS foundation, so you can start at Tier 1 and upgrade to Tier 2 later without rebuilding. The incremental cost is the delta between tiers plus a small migration fee.

6. Why the Pricing Looks the Way It Does

These discounts are intentional. Three drivers:

- 4. Showcase client. DURO’s portfolio — ULI-awarded, DC DGS, heritage-forward — is exactly the reference case The Livingstone Solution wants in our book.
- 5. Re-usable component system. We’ve already built the Next.js + Payload base we’re adapting for DURO. We pass the savings on.
- 6. Ongoing partnership. We’re pricing the website as an investment in the relationship, not a one-off. The \$159/month partnership retainer (see §7) is where the ongoing work lives.

Market benchmarks

Project type (DC metro, Next.js stack)	Typical market quote	DURO tier equivalent	DURO price
5-page Next.js site for a small professional-services firm	\$10,000 – \$15,000	Tier 1	\$3,500
Custom 10-page Next.js site + CMS + blog + GEO	\$22,000 – \$32,000	Tier 2	\$6,400

The simple way to read this:

At Tier 1, DURO gets a credible Next.js site that would cost \$10,000–\$15,000 elsewhere — for \$3,500. At Tier 2, a full competitive-parity build with GEO and content that agencies quote at \$22,000–\$32,000 — for \$6,400. Either way, the highest-ROI marketing dollar DURO can spend in 2026.

7. The Partnership Offer — \$159/month

When the project is delivered and DURO is satisfied, we offer a monthly partnership retainer that keeps the site healthy, secure, and improving. This is optional and starts only after launch.

What's included at \$159/month

- **Hosting.** Vercel + Supabase on our account. Zero downtime, global edge network, automatic SSL, backups. The sites we run have historically stayed up >99.99%.
- **Bug fixes.** If anything breaks — a form stops working, a page errors, CMS glitches — we fix it. Response within one business day.
- **Cybersecurity.** Dependency updates, security patches, monitoring, WAF/CDN protection, regular vulnerability scans, and incident response if something happens.

Why this matters

Most agencies hand off the site and disappear. DURO is a small firm serving public-sector clients — a broken contact form or a security incident at an inopportune moment can cost a task-order win. The \$159/month retainer means DURO never has to think about infrastructure, and the site keeps getting better over time, not worse.

Retainer excludes

- New features or major redesigns — quoted separately as a small SOW.
- Content writing beyond minor edits — available as a content add-on.

8. What We Need From DURO

To move fast, we'll need the following once you approve the tier:

- **Project assets:** high-res photos, renderings, team headshots, logos (vector if possible). We can professionally photograph DC-based projects if needed — add-on \$1,200.
- **Domain:** confirm the domain you want; we'll handle registration and DNS (durodesigngroup.com appears available as of April 2026; to be verified at signing).
- **Content inputs:** existing capabilities statement (we have it), project deck (we have it), and a 45-minute kickoff call covering firm voice, tone, and 2–3 comparable sites you like.
- **Single approver:** one decision-maker named at signing to review design comps and sign off at milestones.

Timeline by tier

- **Tier 1:** 3–4 weeks. Kickoff → wireframes (wk 1) → design (wk 2) → build (wk 3) → launch (wk 4).
- **Tier 2:** 6–7 weeks. Adds content writing, full SEO + GEO, LinkedIn setup, booking integration.

Payment terms

- 50% at signing, 25% at design approval, 25% at launch.
- Scope additions quoted as a line item; nothing silently billed.
- Hosting and partnership retainer (\$159/mo) begin at launch, month-to-month, cancel anytime.

9. Agreed Scope and Next Steps

DURO has selected Tier 1 — Essential Presence (\$3,500). This gets DURO online with a credible, fast-loading Next.js site in 3–4 weeks — discoverable by procurement officers, GC teaming partners, and recruits. It's the fastest path to closing the digital gap that the Market Intelligence Report identified. When DURO is ready, upgrading to Tier 2 adds GEO, thought-leadership content, and full competitive parity with EHT Traceries and Bell — at an incremental cost, no rebuild required.

Next steps

7. We send a short SOW + invoice for the 50% deposit (\$1,750).
8. Kickoff call scheduled within 5 business days of signing.
9. First design comp in your inbox 7–14 days after kickoff.
10. Launch within 3–4 weeks. Training and handoff follow immediately.
11. Optional: \$159/month partnership retainer (hosting + bug fixes + cybersecurity) begins at launch.

Let's build.

SOW in your hands within 24 hours of confirmation.

— *The Livingstone Solution team*